

# Make the first optimize the product moment.

ProTune should stop asking new users to discover its value. Deliver one guided, local, reversible optimize first; monetize only after that proof; then create a reason to return.

**30**

iOS openers

**17**

reached camera

**8**

started optimize

**2.3%**

approx. D1 return

## PRODUCT THESIS

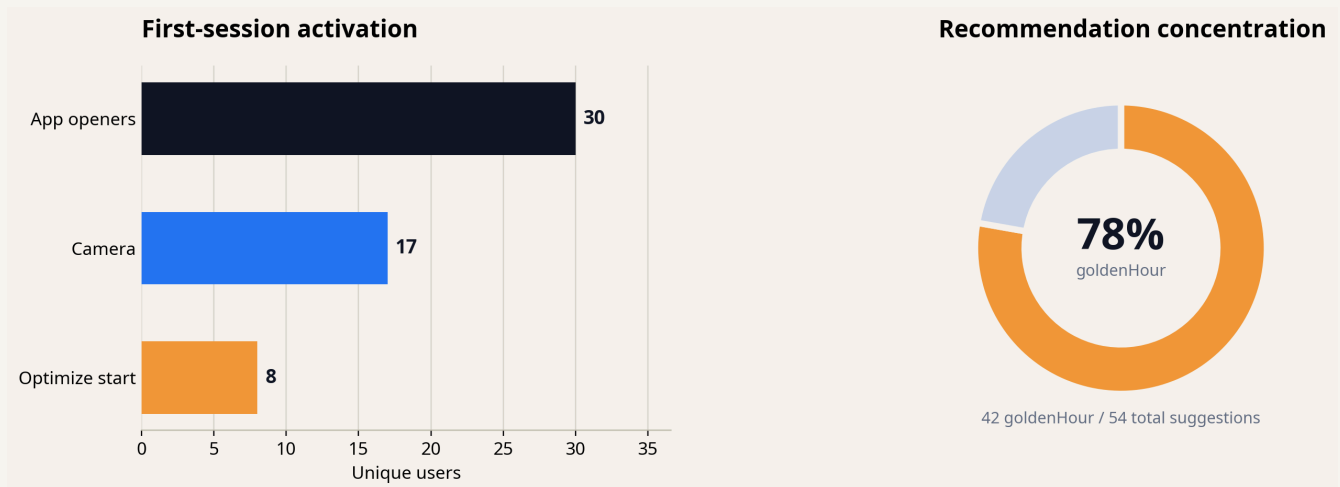
Camera + Optimize is the wedge. Recipes, teaching, browser capture, and paid acquisition should not outrun a reliable first-result loop.

## DECISION

Ship activation and paywall sequencing first. Follow with post-success retention and recommendation quality. Treat the web as an App Store acquisition surface until browser camera reliability is proven.

Directional proposal based on a small sample. Targets in this document are product decision gates, not forecasts.

# The first-value loop leaks before users feel the “pop.”



## ACTIVATION

**9 of 17 camera users did not start Auto Optimize**

Camera reach is not the same as value delivery. Only 47% of camera openers started the core action.

## MONETIZATION

**12 of 22 paywall viewers lacked a successful optimize**

More than half saw monetization before the available data shows they experienced success.

## RETENTION

**26 of 30 opens were one-and-done**

The product currently has neither a strong completion loop nor an operating D1 reminder.

## What the sample establishes

The sequence is misaligned: open → camera → **uncertain value** → paywall → little return. The correct product response is to shorten time-to-proof, not add explanations.

**What it does not establish:** causal impact, stable conversion rates, or which CTA treatment wins. Onboarding, App Tracking Transparency, and recommendation telemetry were dark until the October 6 server event-acceptance fix.

# Ship a guided first win, not another tutorial.

The first eligible capture should automatically run the local optimizer, reveal the before/after immediately, and keep Undo persistent. A large manual “Auto Optimize” control remains visible before capture and on every later session.

## Recommended product behavior

**Auto-run once, after the first successful capture** - not merely when the camera opens. This guarantees an image exists, avoids unexpected background work, and makes the transformation attributable to the user’s action.

### FIRST-SESSION JOURNEY

- 1 **Camera lands ready.** Keep capture primary; place a high-contrast “Auto Optimize” action in the thumb zone with one line of benefit copy.
- 2 **First capture auto-runs locally.** Show progress in place. Never route the first win through the cloud.
- 3 **Reveal before/after.** Use a press-and-hold or scrub comparison, with the optimized result shown by default.
- 4 **Keep Undo and Save visible.** Control reduces the perceived risk of automatic changes.
- 5 **Only then introduce Pro.** The first paywall opportunity follows a saved or clearly acknowledged success.

### PRODUCT RULES

#### Eligibility

- First captured photo in a new install.
- Local model ready and no processing job active.
- Skip auto-run after prior undo or explicit opt-out.

#### Failure behavior

- Preserve the original without interruption.
- Replace progress with “Try Auto Optimize.”
- Do not show a paywall after a failed attempt.

#### Do not add

- Multi-screen tutorial.
- Mandatory coach mark.
- Cloud retry in the critical path.

### PRIMARY GATE

**Camera → optimize start  $\geq 70\%$**   
Current: 47% (8/17)

### QUALITY GATE

**Optimize success is instrumented**  
Baseline unavailable today

### GUARDRAIL

**No regression in failure or crash rate**  
Compare by app version

## Monetize after proof, not before it.

The paywall should be sequenced by success, not by opening a screen. Give every new user a complete first result, then present Pro as the way to keep the momentum.

| MOMENT                      | EXPERIENCE                                             | COMMERCIAL RULE                                      |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Before first success</b> | Camera, capture, local optimize, comparison, save.     | <b>No hard paywall</b>                               |
| <b>After first success</b>  | Compact benefit sheet tied to the result just created. | Soft paywall; "Keep using free" remains visible.     |
| <b>Welcome window</b>       | Up to 10 successful optimizes in the first 24 hours.   | Count only successful outputs, not taps or failures. |
| <b>After welcome</b>        | Return to the standard 5 successful optimizes per day. | Hard gate only when the user hits the quota.         |
| <b>Plan choice</b>          | Yearly leads; monthly remains plainly available.       | No preselected purchase without clear consent.       |

### PAYWALL MESSAGE

#### Anchor to the result

"Your photo is optimized. Go Pro for unlimited edits, premium looks, and exports." Show the user's actual result behind the sheet where technically safe.

### WHY YEARLY LEADS

#### Use the only observed purchase as direction, not proof

One annual sale in 30 days justifies placing yearly first, but not removing monthly or claiming a stable preference.

### Entitlement logic must follow successful output

Quota increments on `optimize_success`. A timeout, cancel, retry, or failed save must not consume a free use or trigger the hard gate.

### PRIMARY GATE

**≥90% of first paywalls occur after success**

### SECONDARY

**Free quota hit → purchase start**

### GUARDRAIL

**No drop in first optimize success**

The 10-use welcome window is a proposed launch setting. Revisit it after two complete weekly cohorts with valid quota and success events.

# A saved result should create the reason to return.

## POST-SUCCESS LOOP

### Celebrate the outcome

Show a clean before/after card after save, with a single next action: "Try another photo." Avoid feature menus at this moment.

### Ask for reminder permission after value

Only after the first successful save, offer a concrete benefit: a reminder to optimize another photo tomorrow.

### Schedule a real local notification

Send once, roughly one day after success, deep-linked to Camera. Cancel if the user returns first.

### Replace Push Exp 1

Retire the zero-send experiment. The replacement is a deterministic lifecycle trigger with schedule, delivery, open, and cancel telemetry.

## D1 MESSAGE CONCEPT

### One useful prompt, not generic engagement

**Headline:** Ready for another quick polish?

**Body:** Open Camera and get an optimized result in one tap.

Avoid a golden-hour promise unless the product has reliable light or time context.

# Recommendation quality must beat recommendation volume.

## 42 of 54 suggestions were goldenHour

That 78% concentration, paired with weak apply, is a quality warning. Do not force artificial variety; diagnose whether scoring, eligibility, or fallback logic defaults too often to goldenHour.

## Auto-apply only the top eligible look

Apply the strongest recommendation to the preview after optimize, preserve the unstyled optimize underneath, and keep Undo visible. If confidence is insufficient, show suggestions without auto-apply.

| MEASURE               | WHAT IT ANSWERS                        | DECISION USE                         |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| Suggested → applied   | Does the recommendation earn a tap?    | Rank model and presentation quality. |
| Auto-applied → undone | Was the automatic choice trusted?      | Set or tighten eligibility.          |
| Applied → saved       | Did the look improve the final result? | Prefer outcomes over clicks.         |

# Make the core loop measurable and dependable before scaling it.

## IOS PROCESSING

### Local-first is a product promise

- First optimize always uses the local path.
- Cloud fallback stays behind a feature flag, outside onboarding.
- Expose a retry only after preserving the original.
- Segment success, latency, and failure by processing path.

## WEB ACQUISITION

### App Store first; browser camera second

- Make the App Store badge the dominant landing-page action.
- Demote browser camera to “Try the preview” while errors persist.
- Track badge click, preview start, error, and successful result.
- Do not optimize the current 20 → 3 CTA path until reliability is known.

## Product order matters

Reliability supports the first win; acquisition follows it. Do not send paid traffic into a path whose success rate cannot yet be reconstructed.

## LOCAL

### First-session default

Fast, private, resilient

## CLOUD

### Flagged fallback

Outside onboarding

## WEB

### Acquisition first

Preview is secondary

# One event contract should reconstruct the whole journey.

| EVENT                                        | REQUIRED CONTEXT                                      | PRODUCT QUESTION                        |
|----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| app_open, camera_view                        | app_version, build, session_id, source                | Where do new users enter and drop?      |
| capture_success                              | is_first_capture, permission_state                    | Did camera use produce an input?        |
| optimize_start                               | trigger: auto/manual; path: local/cloud               | Did the core action begin, and why?     |
| optimize_success / optimize_fail             | latency_ms, path, error_class                         | Did value arrive reliably?              |
| look_suggested, look_applied, look_undone    | look_id, rank, auto_applied                           | Which recommendation earns a save?      |
| paywall_view                                 | <b>paywall_trigger</b> , had_success, quota_remaining | Was monetization sequenced after value? |
| free_quota_hit                               | quota_limit, successful_uses, day_index               | Does scarcity produce intent?           |
| notification_scheduled / notification_opened | campaign_id, delay_bucket                             | Does the D1 loop create return?         |

## Release-blocking telemetry check

Verify every event lands with **app\_version**, build, and a stable anonymous session/user key; confirm unknown valid event names are accepted; and inspect the first 20 complete journeys end to end.

### Required dimensions

New/returning, app version, build, processing path, trigger, result, quota state, and elapsed time.

### Data boundary

Do not send photo contents, raw image metadata, or user-entered text. Keep properties limited to behavior and system outcome.

The onboarding, ATT, and recommendation funnel needs a fresh baseline after the October 6 event-acceptance fix; prior absence should not be read as user behavior.

# Ship the funnel in three increments, with one decision at each gate.

| INCREMENT            | SCOPE                                                                                                                 | EXIT GATE                                                                                      |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A • Observe</b>   | Event acceptance check; app_version/build; optimize outcome; paywall_trigger; free_quota_hit; path and error context. | 20 end-to-end journeys reconstruct cleanly.                                                    |
| <b>B • First win</b> | First-capture local auto-run; large manual CTA; before/after; Undo; paywall after success; 10-success welcome window. | Camera → start ≥70%; ≥90% of first paywalls follow success.                                    |
| <b>C • Return</b>    | Post-save next action; D1 local reminder; retire Push Exp 1; top-look auto-apply with eligibility and Undo.           | D1 improves across two complete weekly cohorts without notification complaints or undo spikes. |
| <b>D • Acquire</b>   | App Store badge first on web; preview secondary; validate browser camera separately.                                  | App Store click-through is measurable; browser preview has a known success rate.               |

## SCORECARD

|                      |                                                  |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Activation</b>    | New opener → optimize success                    |
| <b>Time to value</b> | Camera view → first success                      |
| <b>Monetization</b>  | Post-success paywall → purchase start/completion |
| <b>Retention</b>     | D1 return after first success                    |
| <b>Quality</b>       | Save, undo, failure, and latency by path         |

## DO NOT BUILD NOW

### Keep the product narrow

- No expanded Recipe or Teach investment.
- No new cloud dependency in first session.
- No broad push campaign before a working trigger.
- No paid-install scale-up until first success and D1 are moving.
- No premature multivariate test on this traffic level.

## Recommended approval

Approve Increments A and B as the next iOS product release. Treat C as the immediate follow-on after telemetry validation. Run D independently on the web. Keep the core promise simple: **capture, optimize, compare, save.**

**Measurement note:** With the current sample, use sequential weekly cohorts and inspect actual journeys. Promote to controlled holdouts only when each path has enough traffic to avoid single-user swings.